Part – I Working with OpenOffice Calc

7.1 Introduction to spreadsheet

Spreadsheet is a very useful office automation tool to organise, analyse and store data in a tabular form. Spreadsheet was developed as computerized equivalent to paper-based accounting worksheets.

Spreadsheet users can adjust any of the stored values and can observe the effects on the calculated values. This is called "What if" analysis. Modern spreadsheet can have multiple interacting sheets and can display data either as text or numerals or in a graphical form.

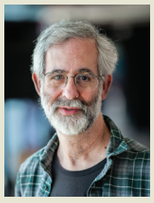
7.1.1 Evolution of Spreadsheet

Daniel Bricklin and Bob Frankston developed the first spreadsheet called "VisiCalc" in 1979 for Apple II. In 1982, Lotus Corporation introduced "Lotus 1-2-3"; Lotus 1-2-3 was the first to introduce cell names and macros. In 1987, Microsoft Corporation introduced Excel. Excel implemented a Graphical User Interface (GUI) and the ability to point and click using a mouse. There are lots of other spreadsheet applications; Microsoft Excel continues to be the most popular spreadsheet software.

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DO YOU KNOW?

Daniel Singer "Dan" Bricklin The Father of Spreadsheet



Daniel Singer "Dan" Bricklin (born 16 July 1951), often referred to as "The Father of the Spreadsheet", is the American co-creator, with Bob Frankston, of the VisiCalc spreadsheet. He also founded Software Garden, Inc., of which he is currently President of Trellix Corporation, which is currently owned by Web.com. He currently serves as the Chief Technology Officer of Alpha Software.

OpenOffice Calc is a popular open source spreadsheet application maintained by Apache Foundation. StarOffice calc was the parent application of OpenOffice Calc which was developed by a German Company namely, Star Division in 1985.

7.2 Working with OpenOffice Calc

Calc is the spreadsheet component of OpenOffice. You can enter any kind of data in a spreadsheet and then manipulate this data to produce certain results. Alternatively, you can enter data and then use Calc in a 'What If...' manner by changing some of the data and observing the results without having to retype the entire spreadsheet.

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